Team Expectations Agreement[1]

When working in a team, problems occasionally arise. One source of problems is the differing expectations of team members. For example, one person may think that an email response should come within 2 hours, while another may think that 2 days is acceptable.

This document will serve as a guideline while working on establishing team expectations. In the space below, write down the list of agreed upon guidelines that your team intends to follow. Include guidelines for the following:

- **Methods of communication** (email, phone, messenger, text, ...)
- **Communication response times** (email, phone, messenger, text, ...)
- **Meeting attendance** (when to meet, whether all meetings are mandatory, ...)
- **Running meetings** (when, where, face-to-face vs. online, who takes minutes, ...)
- **Meeting preparation** (whether preparation is needed, what to prepare, ...)
- **Version control** (what to/not to commit, content of log messages, ...)
- **Division of work** (how to divide work, who will decide who does what, ...)
- **Submitting assignments** (when to submit, who will submit, who will review the submission, ...)
- **Contingency planning** (what if a team member drops out, what if a team member consistently misses meetings, what if a team member is academically dishonest, ...) We suggest that in these cases, a team promptly seeks help from the instructor. It is important not to let such situations escalate.

The list above is just meant to get you started. If you had any team problems in the past, think about what went wrong and how expectations can be set to prevent those types of problems.

(Continued on the other side.)

[1] Based on *Turning Groups into Effective Teams*, Barbara Oakley et al., 2004.

Team Guidelines (continued)

We accept these guidelines (written in the page 3 of this document) and intend to fulfill them (sign below):

Name (print)	**Signature**	**Date**
Taisia Zhizhina		October 10 2025
Timothy Tolstinev		October 10 2025
Akhandi Amangeldi		October 11 2025
Parnia Esfandiari	Parnia	October 11, 2025

At the time when you will submit the sprint 0 materials, please submit this document as well. In the event of team disagreements, you may be asked to show this form to your instructor.

Team Guidelines (continued)

Please write down your guidelines in this page.

- The main method of communication is through Discord Server, email can be secondary communication.
- If someone is not answering through discord or email and we need time sensitive communication with them (like right before a deadline) phone numbers may be used for texting or calling. (Open with your name on the first time)
- Respond as soon as available, no later than 24h if messaged directly or tagged
- Time, place and any necessary preparations for each meeting will be decided at least a day ahead with all members verbally agreeing to time and attendance
- Meetings held through discord voice channel unless previously agreed to be in person
- Only commit code that runs without errors, and/or any code that another member requires to do their part
- When committing work to the discord only commit work that you have done (unless previously agreed upon) so that the commits accurately reflect who did what.
- Properly type your log messages (debug, info, error), debug for any minor messages that are used for your own testing (like if an if statement was executed), info for general record of the applications operation (like a book being successfully or unsuccessfully added to the list), error only for serious issues.
- Division of work decided upon in meetings with everyone present, everyone gets a say in what they want to work on but we try to split work up evenly while keeping that in mind
- Members who are busy for a short period of time (a week or so) and cannot take on a lot of work for that period will be accommodated by being given a smaller work load, however the period may not exceed two weeks.
- If you're unable to finish work you have committed to promptly inform the rest of the group in the discord so that the work can be reallocated/everyone is on the same page
- Do not wait until the last minute to submit work. Try to finish work a day before or morning of, so that the rest of the team has enough time to look over it. Edge case submit work at least an hour before the deadline.
- If something has to be submitted by one person in the e-class the person will be decided upon in the Discord some time before the deadline.
- In case of team member dropping out or not contributing, we will inform the instructor and possibly reduce scope of project